

Jim Pham
Autobiography
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I was born in Vietnam and grew up alongside my two brothers and two sisters. In 1980, we immigrated to America as refugees. My father, a Captain in the South Vietnamese Army, was captured after the Vietnam War in 1975 and spent thirteen years in a re-education camp. Our family was finally reunited in 1988 after he escaped communist Vietnam and made his way to America. My mother was a homemaker. Despite their limited educational backgrounds, they instilled in me the values of intellectual achievement and encouraged me to make the most of my talents.

We began our new life in America with virtually no financial resources. For an extended period, we relied on government-subsidized income and housing to survive. My siblings and I were educated through the public school system. In 1986, our family relocated from Columbus, Ohio, to San Jose, California. I graduated from Silver Creek High School in 1987, and the following year, I enrolled at San Jose State University, where I earned both a Bachelor of Science and a Master of Science in Computer Engineering. Thankfully, much of my college education was funded by Cal Grant and other financial aid programs for low-income students; without this support, affording an education would have been impossible for my siblings and me. Despite my parents having limited educational backgrounds, all of us successfully obtained college degrees. My two brothers and I earned degrees in engineering; one sister earned an advanced degree in education; and my older sister graduated with a degree in accounting. I

was the first in my family to achieve a college degree and the first in my generation to pursue higher education.

For the past fifteen years, I have served as a design engineer in the computer industry, most recently at Oracle and PeopleSoft. Prior to that, I dedicated five years to Lockheed and IBM. My background includes extensive experience in software design, with a focus on Object-Oriented Design (OOD), user interfaces, web technologies, and multi-platform tools. Additionally, I spent eight years as a computer science instructor at Ohlone College. In my engineering career, I have gained hands-on experience in architecting enterprise software applications and addressing complex business challenges. Throughout my professional journey, I have submitted five patent applications, published numerous hardware and software designs, and written millions of lines of code in C/C++, .NET, and J2EE/Java.

My journey at Ohlone College has taken an exciting turn, allowing me to pursue a Doctor of Education. I firmly believe that education should empower every individual to absorb and apply knowledge effectively. It should serve as a tool for all to learn, find joy in discovery, understand their lives, and engage in critical reasoning. An enriching education not only fosters the acquisition of knowledge but also cultivates a deeper appreciation of fundamental truths. Ultimately, this kind of education shapes individuals, enhancing their understanding of the world around them.

I'm taking two online courses this summer for the first time, and I have no prior experience with online education.

My experience with the study of law, ethics, and equity is limited. I have received ethics training from my employers (PeopleSoft, Oracle, Lockheed, and IBM), and I understand right from wrong.

Dissertation Topic: I aim to integrate technology into the teaching and learning environment. In a recent project from Dr. Shenk's class, I authored an article on web-based student services as an alternative to traditional campus-based services. I aspire to take this concept further by developing a comprehensive online learning solution.

I aim to deepen my understanding of school law, ethics, and equity.